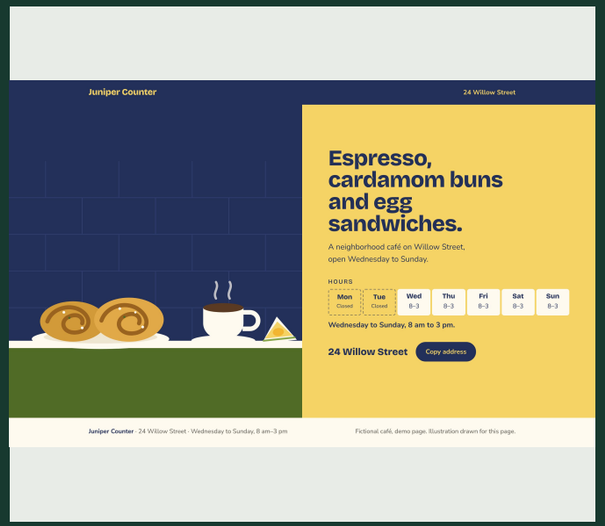
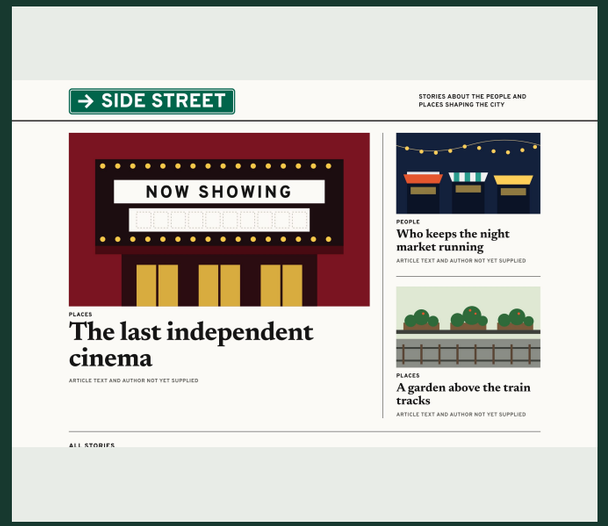
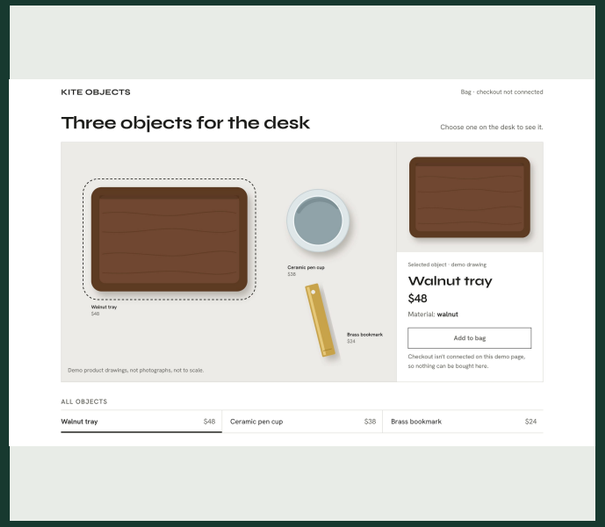
DESIGN SKILL / FIVE TESTS

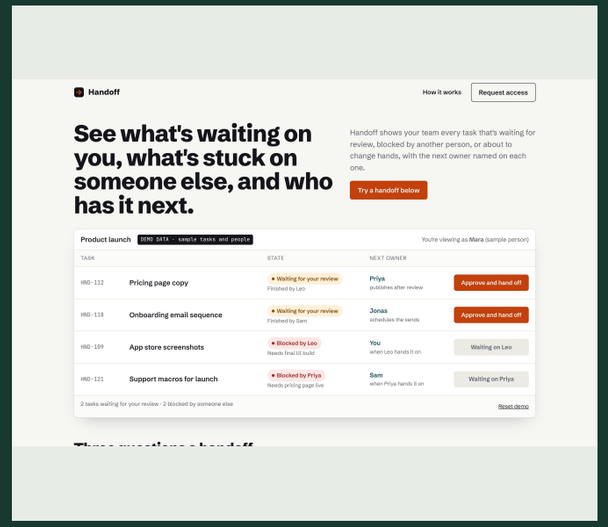
# CLEARER. STILL NOT FINISHED.

A visual review of five different websites, with concrete fixes for the pages and rules Claude can use on future projects.




JUNIPER / KITE / SIDE STREET / NORTH LIBRARY / HANDOFF

THE RESULT

# Five different types, three repeated gaps

The skill improved task clarity and honest demo labeling. Visual substance still varies widely.

| SITE | WHAT WORKS | MAIN VISUAL ISSUE | BEST NEXT MOVE |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Juniper Counter** | Hours and address visible | Large empty navy field | Make food imagery carry the hero |
| **Kite Objects** | Objects can be selected | Drawings lack scale and detail | Add true-to-product evidence |
| **Side Street** | Strong editorial composition | No story can be read | Solve the content shortage |
| **North Library** | Clear rooms and validation | Demo caveats dominate | Simplify labels; fix action verbs |
| **Handoff** | Working product demonstration | Long intro; generic brand | Lead with the interface sooner |
| | | | |

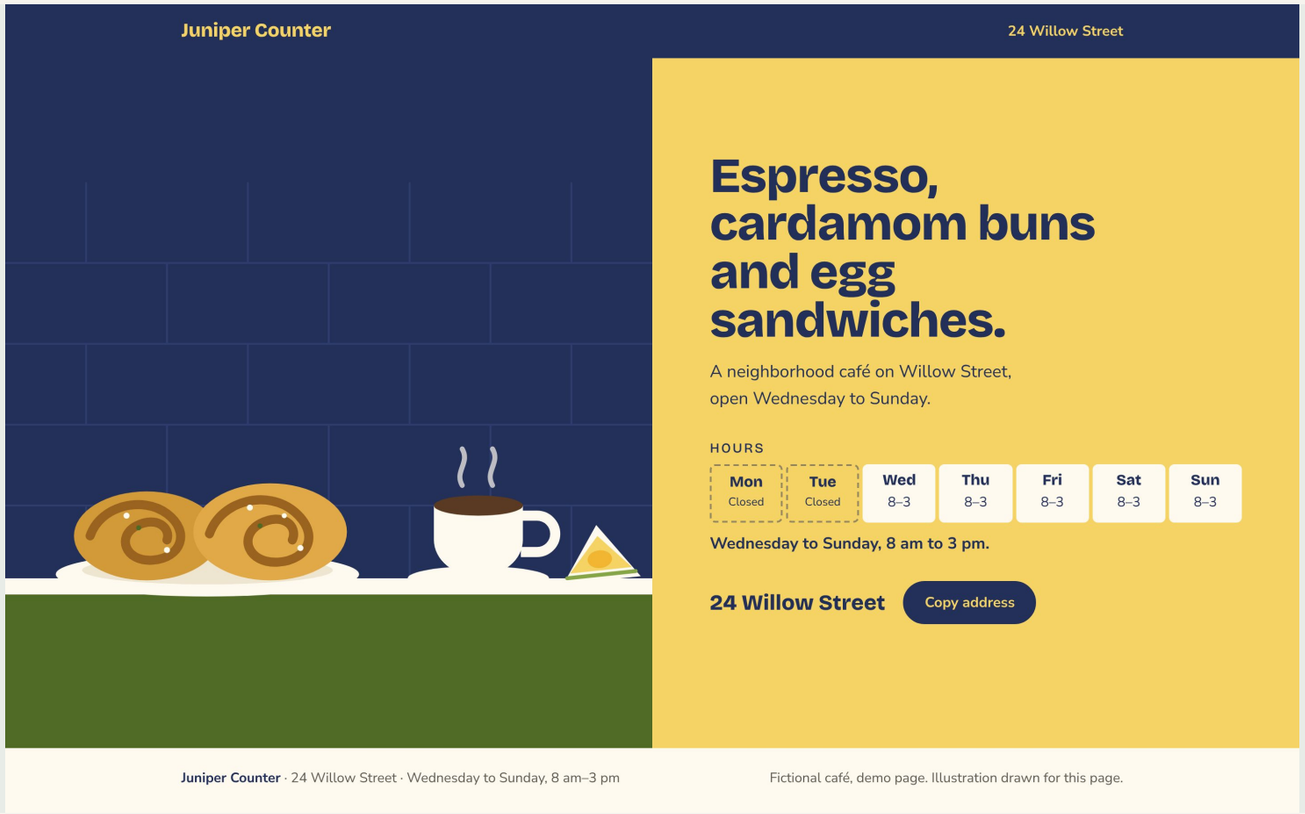
CORE FINDING

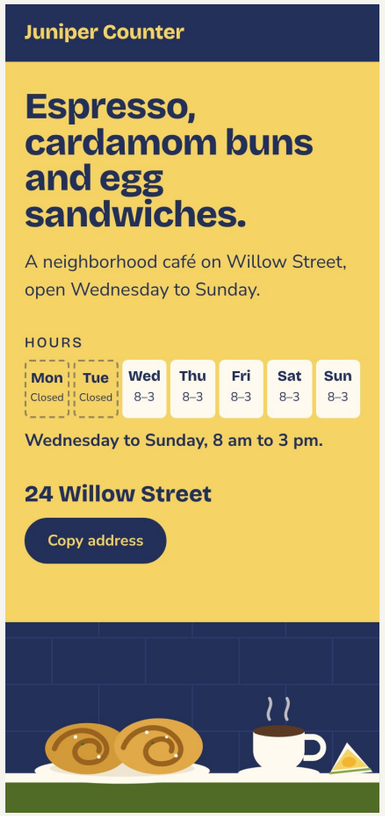
The five sites are more distinct than the earlier radio test. The recurring failure is not a single color or component. Sparse real material becomes flat illustration, repeated demo warnings, or an experience that cannot complete its promised task.

CAFE

# Juniper Counter

Desktop and mobile first screens from the submitted test.




SUBMITTED SCREENSHOTS / VISUAL REVIEW ONLY

### WHAT WORKS

The yellow and navy palette is memorable. Address and hours are visible without guessing.

### WHAT HOLDS IT BACK

On desktop the upper half of the left panel is mostly empty. The café illustration sits at the bottom, so the first screen feels like a layout awaiting a photo.

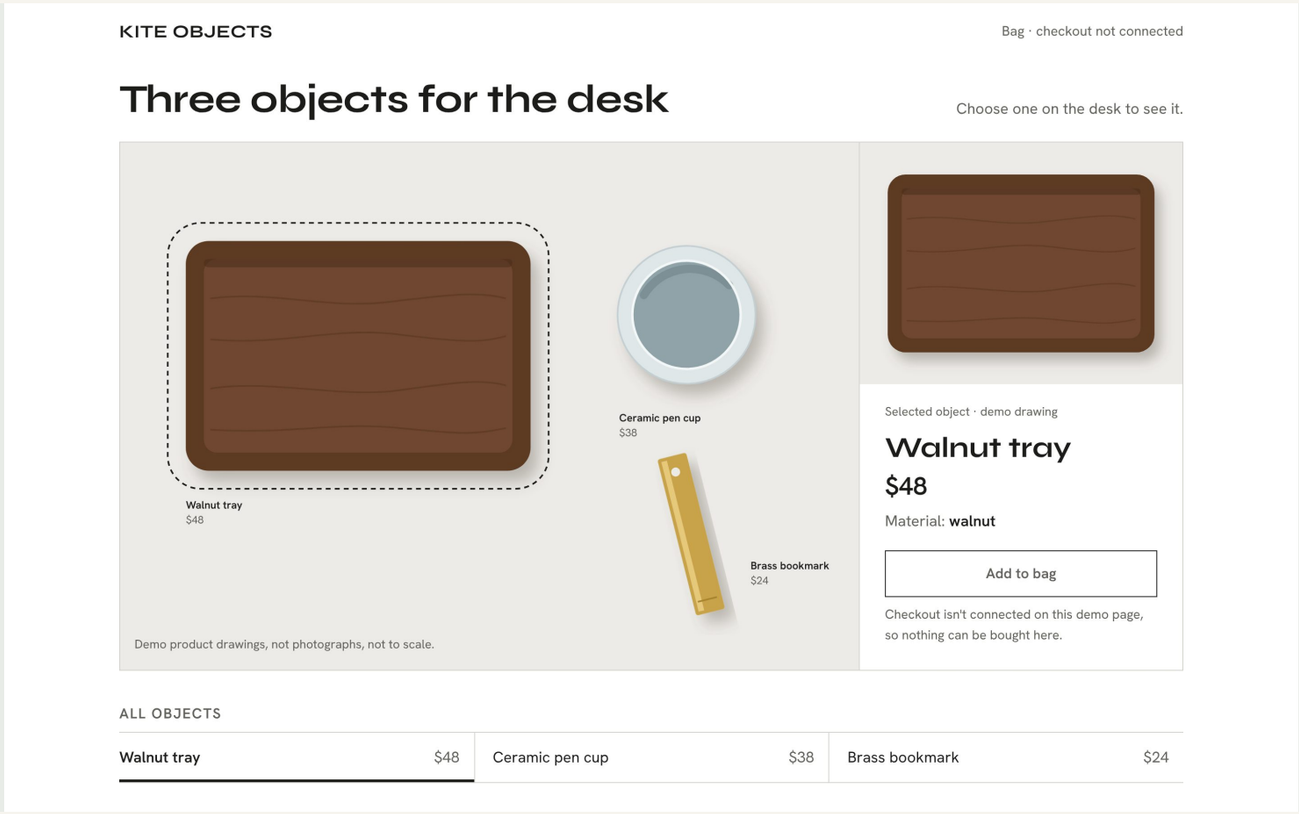
### SPECIFIC NEXT PASS

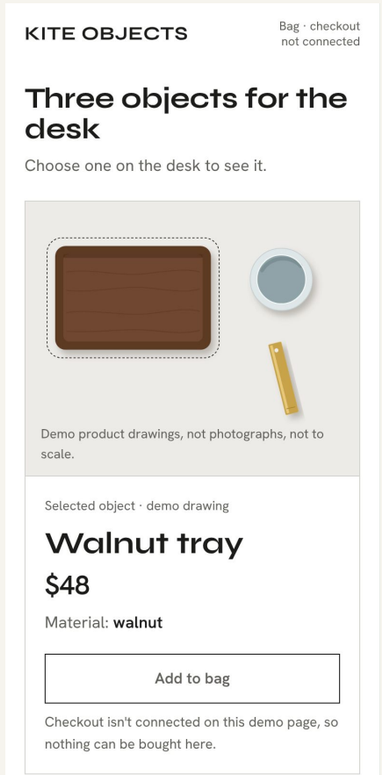
Move the food or counter scene into the visual center. Use an approved photo of food or the room if one exists. If photos cannot be sourced, make the illustration richer and compose it at hero scale. Simplify the seven-day strip to a clear hours line.

STORE

# Kite Objects

Desktop and mobile first screens from the submitted test.




SUBMITTED SCREENSHOTS / VISUAL REVIEW ONLY

## WHAT WORKS

The top-down desk is an original shopping concept. The three products and prices are easy to compare.

## WHAT HOLDS IT BACK

The objects are schematic. A shopper cannot judge size, finish, edges, or how the tray and cup actually look. The disabled bag makes the purchase path a dead end.

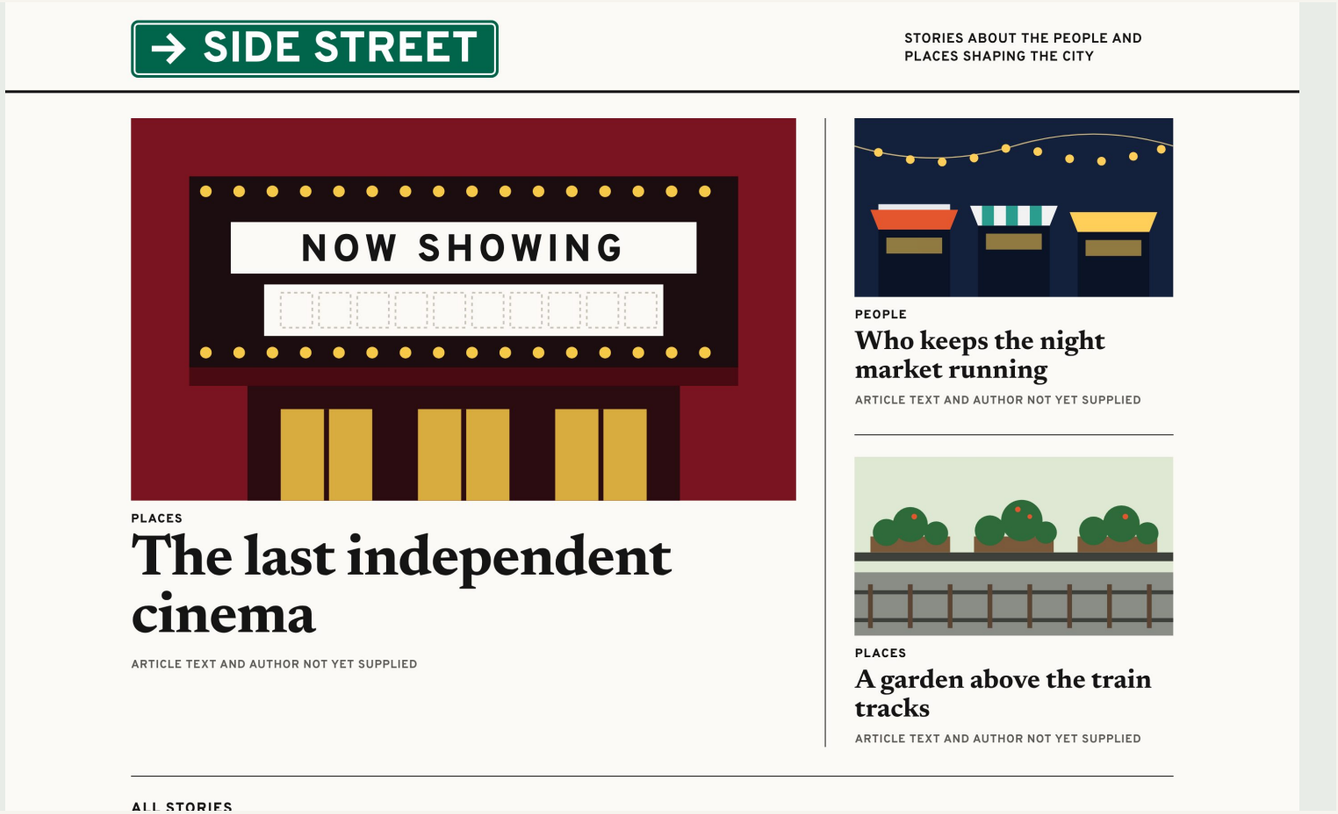
## SPECIFIC NEXT PASS

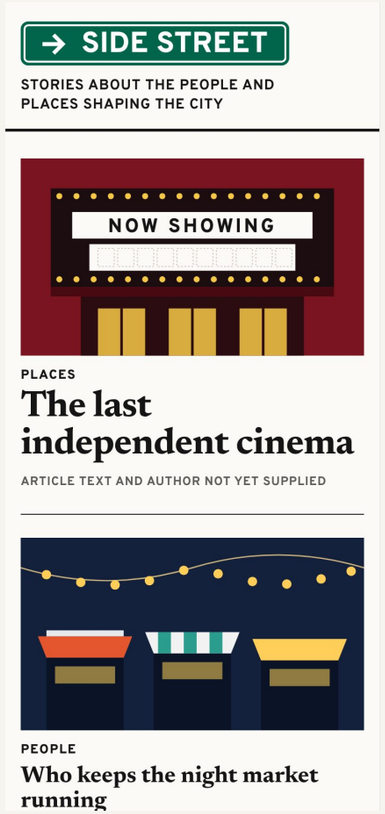
Ask for real product photos and dimensions. For a fictional demo, use carefully crafted concept renders labeled as such, with scale cues and close-up details. Make the action a product preview or demo bag, and label what it does.

MAGAZINE

# Side Street

Desktop and mobile first screens from the submitted test.




SUBMITTED SCREENSHOTS / VISUAL REVIEW ONLY

### WHAT WORKS

The street-sign identity and three custom illustrations give the magazine a coherent editorial voice.

### WHAT HOLDS IT BACK

Every story repeats “article text and author not supplied”; opening one produces an unavailable message. The design promises reading but has no reading experience.

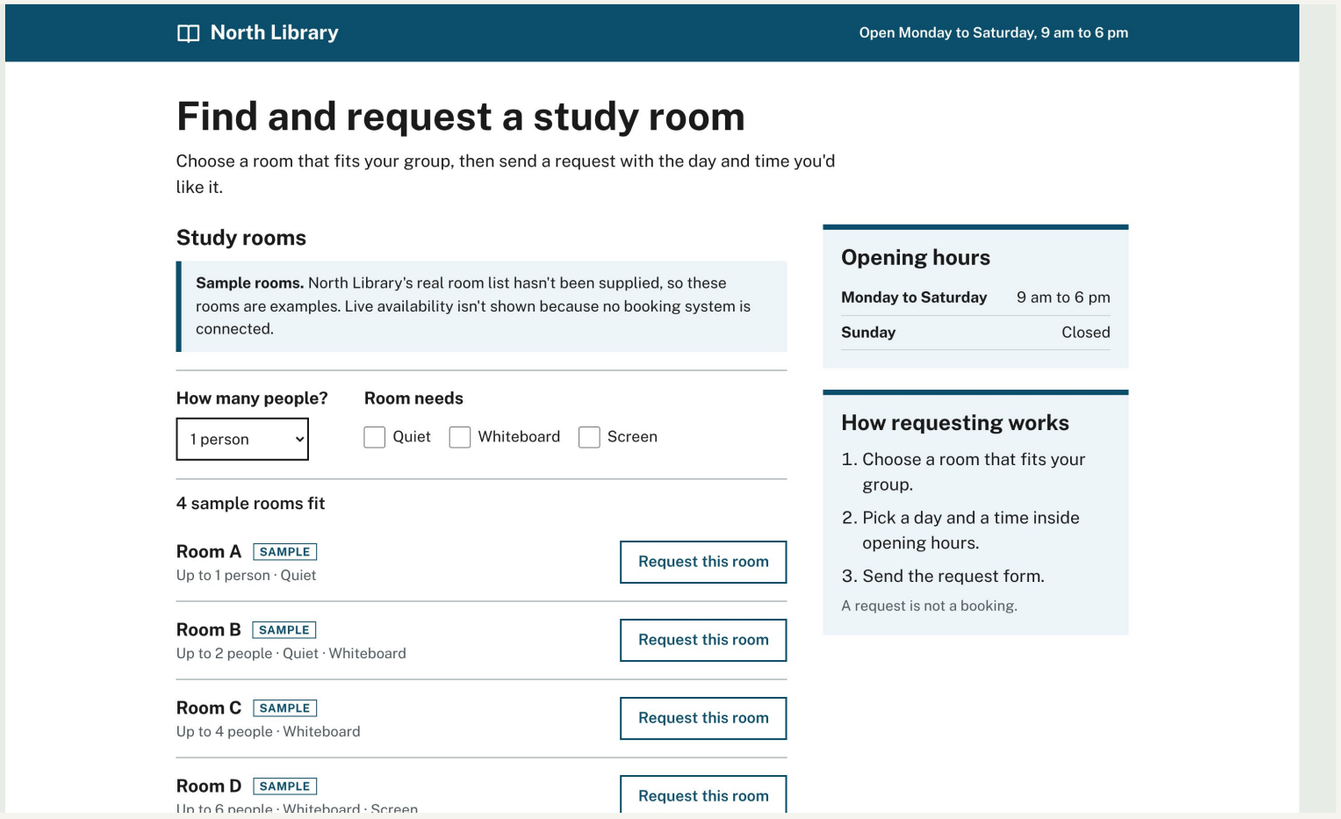
### SPECIFIC NEXT PASS

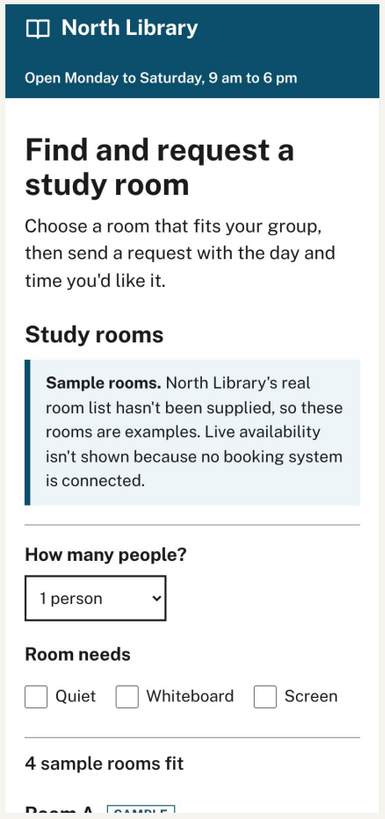
Ask for one complete story or approval to write clearly labeled sample editorial copy. Make that story genuinely readable. For the others, use short real summaries or mark them as upcoming once, not with the same warning on every card.

PUBLIC SERVICE

# North Library

Desktop and mobile first screens from the submitted test.




SUBMITTED SCREENSHOTS / VISUAL REVIEW ONLY

### WHAT WORKS

Plain language, room filtering, visible hours, and useful validation suit a public task.

### WHAT HOLDS IT BACK

Demo warnings occupy prominent space throughout the page. “Check and send request” conflicts with the fact that nothing is sent.

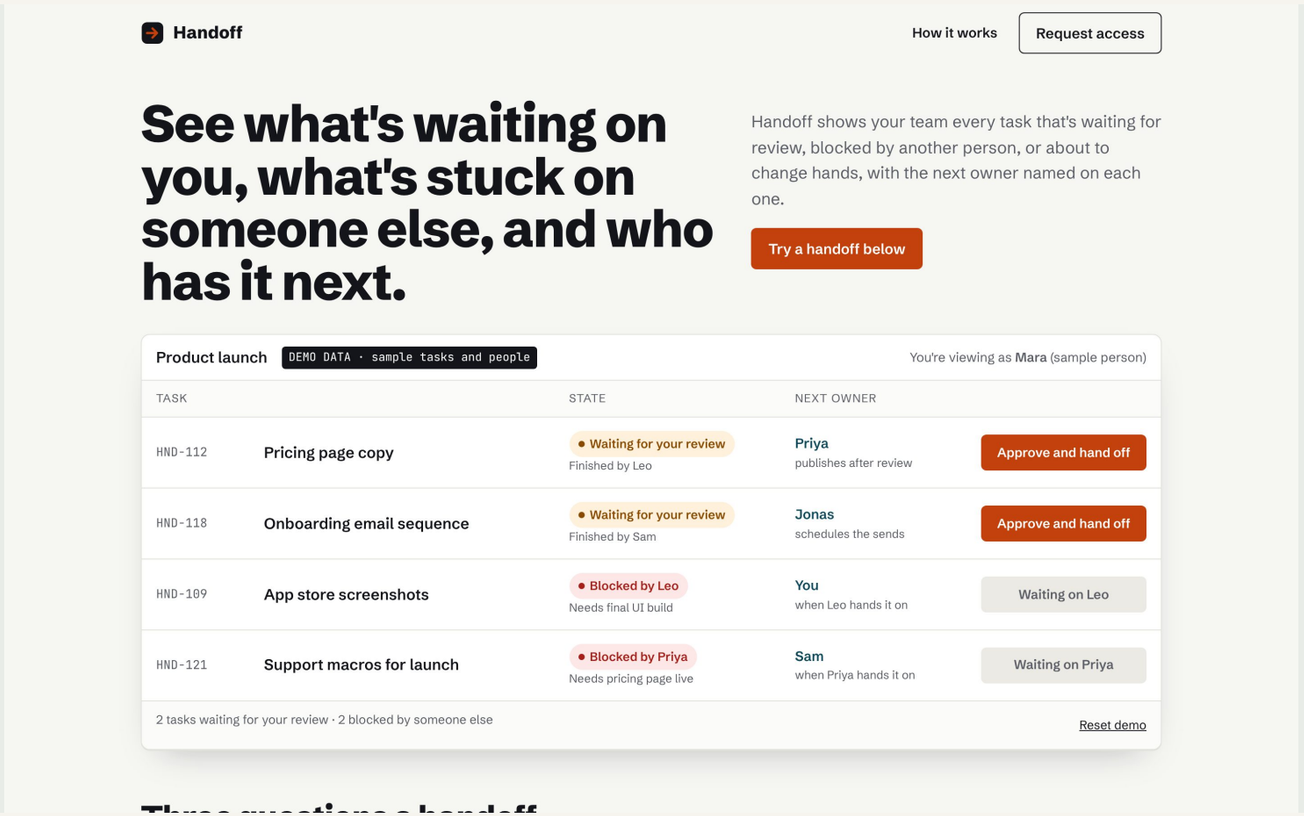
### SPECIFIC NEXT PASS

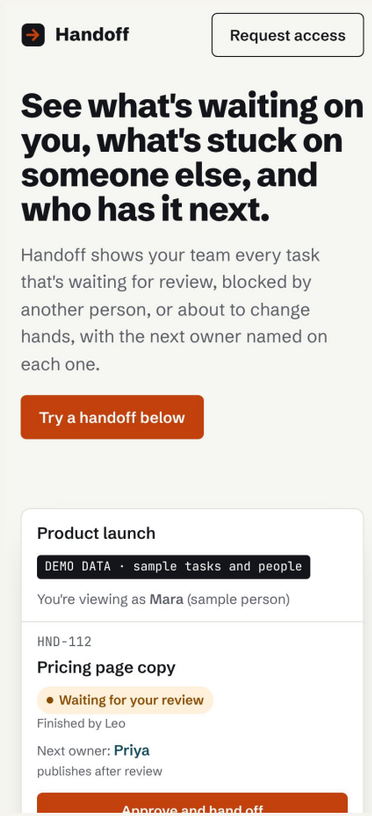
Keep a concise demo notice beside the room list and one at the form. Rename the button “Check request” or “Preview request”; show the checked summary without claiming submission. Preserve the restrained visual style.

SOFTWARE PRODUCT

# Handoff

Desktop and mobile first screens from the submitted test.




SUBMITTED SCREENSHOTS / VISUAL REVIEW ONLY

### WHAT WORKS

The sample board makes the product concrete, and the handoff interaction changes state visibly.

### WHAT HOLDS IT BACK

The long headline and paragraph push the working demo down on mobile. The white, black, and orange branding is competent but largely interchangeable.

### SPECIFIC NEXT PASS

Shorten the opening claim and surface the board earlier. Give the product one specific visual cue drawn from ownership flow, while keeping the table readable. Check whether “Request access” is connected; if not, label it as a demo.

CROSS-SITE DIAGNOSIS

# The problems the skill must catch

These are generalized lessons from the set; none requires every site to use the same aesthetic.

01 ## Missing material becomes flatness

The café and shop relied on diagram-like illustrations after photo sourcing failed. Original art can work, but it needs the same visual conviction, scale, and detail as a strong photo-led concept.

02 ## Honesty becomes repeated warning text

The store, magazine, and library label limitations so often that the disclaimers become part of the brand. One clear notice at the relevant action can be more truthful and more usable.

03 ## Sparse content blocks the main task

Side Street has stories no one can read; Kite lacks product detail. Before styling, the skill should decide whether the available material supports the promised visitor task.

04 ## A clean screenshot is mistaken for completion

Good spacing and contrast are necessary. The visual review must also judge composition, focal point, real-world texture, and whether the first screen feels finished.

FUTURE ASSET WORKFLOW

# Use real images without getting stuck

A photo is useful only when it fits the subject, is usable, and is honest about what it depicts.

## 1 / Ask for owned material

Request actual place, product, person, or project images when these would change the design. These are the best source of identity.

## 2 / Source for the right job

Use an allowed source with a clear license. Verify the image page, creator, usage terms, and whether attribution is required. Save a local copy and source record.

## 3 / Label illustrative images

For a fictional café or library, an unrelated photo may illustrate atmosphere or activity. It must not be presented as the actual venue. A shop needs true product imagery or clearly labeled concept renders.

## 4 / Stop on download failure

Try one alternative permitted source. If access or licensing remains unclear, stop retrying. Ask the user to upload assets or make original imagery; recompose the page so no empty photo slot remains.

## 5 / Design the image, not just add it

Choose crop, scale, placement, caption, and mobile treatment. A small generic stock rectangle cannot supply identity by itself.

**No network workaround is required for a finished page: a designed fallback is part of the workflow.**

ADD TO CLAUDE SKILL

# A replacement visual review rule

Copy this into the skill as a general workflow, then adapt its wording to the existing files.

```
Before visual design, check whether the available content and assets support the
visitor's main task. Ask for missing facts or imagery that would change the result.
For a fictional demo, representative content may be authored only when clearly
labeled as sample; do not imply that sample facts, people, or imagery are real.

Use the asset ladder: user-provided real material; verified licensed imagery;
original illustration or concept render; then an intentional text-led design.
Choose per project. If an image source fails, make one alternate attempt, then
continue with a composed fallback. Never leave an empty asset slot or stall.

Render desktop and mobile. Inspect the full composition: focal point, whitespace,
visual material, hierarchy, and the first task. If the result only passes a
checklist but feels unfinished, redesign it before delivery.

For demos, disclose the limitation once at the relevant action, use verbs that
describe what actually happens, and avoid repeating warnings in every section.
Compare the finished work across site types; do not force expressive decoration
onto public-service or operating interfaces that benefit from restraint.
```

**Skill principle: honest content and accessible behavior should support the design, not visually overwhelm it.**

NEXT TEST

# Rebuild one; then test a fresh brief

A skill fix is proven by a new result, not by a more detailed checklist.

### 01 / CONTROLLED REPAIR

Rebuild Side Street or Kite Objects with one approved content or image asset supplied. Compare the before and after screenshots. Check that the visitor can complete the promised task.

### 02 / FRESH TRANSFER

Give Claude a new type of site it has not seen in this set. Let it choose a visual direction and asset strategy. Review the result against the same visual questions without coaching the style.

### WHAT TO SEND BACK

For each: first questions, asset sources or fallback decision, desktop and mobile screenshots, a working or honest demo state, and the specific changes made after looking at the render.

PASS WHEN

The page feels specific to its subject, the visual material has a deliberate role, the main task works or is accurately labeled, and the skill reaches a finished design despite missing assets.

Review based on user-provided screenshots; source code and live behavior were not inspected.